NEPQ Phase 2 — Situation

Cheat sheet · 4 Nov 2026

Purpose

Understand what the prospect is **currently doing** to reach their goal, without making them feel wrong about it. Collect the facts now; find the problems in the next phase.

Do / Don't

Do	Don't
Ask about their current approach with genuine interest	Pick apart or criticise what they're doing
Respect the choices they've made	Make them feel stupid for their decisions
Stack questions so each answer leads to the next	Fire off a list of random questions
Keep it subtle and collaborative	Make it obvious you're "building a case"

The question flow

Ask about	Why
What are you doing right now to get [goal]?	Maps their current effort
How long have you been doing that?	Shows how stuck or committed they are
Why did you choose that approach?	Reveals their reasoning and priorities
What do you like about it?	Validates them and keeps trust high
If you could change anything, what would it be?	Opens the door to gaps, gently, in their words

Listen for two kinds of problem

Process: how they do it is the issue (slow, manual, inconsistent, time-consuming).

Outcome: the results are the issue (not enough leads, reviews, sales, weight lost).

Why it works: if you knock their current approach early, they lose confidence in their own judgement and then struggle to decide on anything, including you. Today's buyers are informed and spot "dismantling" tactics fast.

Self-check after each call

- ■ Do I know exactly what they're doing now, and for how long?
- ■ Do I know why they chose it?
- ■ Did they say what they like and what they'd change?
- ■ Can I tell if it's a process or an outcome problem?
- ■ Did they stay confident, not defensive?

Next phase: Problem Awareness — exploring the gaps and their impact, built on what you learned here.